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INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Renovation Cost Intelligence Report

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ESTIMATED COST RANGE

midrange – £63,360

Midlands · Semi · Full spec

PROPERTY TYPE **Semi**	REGION **Midlands**
RENOVATION LEVEL **1920 1960**	SPECIFICATION **Full**
PROPERTY AGE **3**	BEDROOMS **sub80**

Cost benchmarks informed by publicly available data from RICS, BCIS, ONS, Rightmove, Zoopla and HM Land Registry (2025/26). Full methodology at urbanbrief.co.uk/data-sources

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The proposed renovation project for a semi-detached property in the Midlands, built between 1920 and 1960, aims to achieve a full specification upgrade within a midrange budget of approximately £63,360. This project will focus on modernising the interior and exterior features of the home while maintaining the architectural integrity typical of the period. Key objectives include updating the electrical and plumbing systems, improving energy efficiency, and enhancing the overall aesthetic appeal of the property. Given the property's age and size, the renovation will likely involve addressing structural concerns, such as potential dampness or outdated materials, to ensure long-term durability and compliance with current building regulations. The project will be tailored to meet the needs of a family with young children, ensuring safety and functionality are prioritised throughout the design and execution phases.

All figures are 2025/26 indicative estimates exclusive of VAT. Midlands regional multiplier applied.

Interior Renovation Includes kitchen and bathroom updates, flooring, and painting.	**£20,000 – £25,000**
Exterior Works Covers roofing, windows, and façade improvements.	**£10,000 – £15,000**
Systems Upgrade Electrical and plumbing system updates.	**£8,000 – £12,000**
Energy Efficiency Insulation and heating system improvements.	**£5,000 – £8,000**
Contingency Allocated for unforeseen expenses.	**£5,360 – £8,360**

Risks identified based on property type, age and scope. Impact ranges use 2025/26 BCIS remediation data.

Structural Issues

Medium risk

Impact: £10,000

Mitigation: Conduct a thorough structural survey before commencing work.

Planning Delays

Low risk

Impact: £3,000

Mitigation: Engage with local authorities early and ensure all applications are complete and accurate.

These costs are frequently omitted from initial budgets.

Asbestos Removal **£3,000**

Older properties may contain asbestos, which requires specialised removal.

Damp Proofing **£2,500**

Properties of this age may have damp issues that need to be addressed.

It is advisable to set aside a contingency fund of approximately 10-15% of the total project budget to cover unexpected costs. For this project, a contingency of £6,336 to £9,504 would be appropriate. For example, if unforeseen structural repairs are needed, this fund can prevent delays and ensure the project remains on track.

Indicative programme. Durations depend on contractor resource and unforeseen works.

1	**Planning and Design** Develop detailed plans, secure necessary permits, and finalise design specifications.	4 weeks
2	**Demolition and Preparation** Remove outdated materials and prepare the site for renovation.	2 weeks
3	**Construction** Execute structural and interior renovations, including systems upgrades.	8 weeks
4	**Finishing Touches** Complete painting, flooring, and final installations.	2 weeks

Present this checklist to all tendering contractors and include key items as contract conditions.

- Verify contractor's experience with period properties.
- Ensure all contractors are fully insured and accredited.
- Request detailed quotes and timelines from multiple contractors.
- Check references and past project reviews.

Recommended actions in sequence before committing to any contract.

1. Conduct a detailed structural survey.
2. Engage with a local architect familiar with period renovations.
3. Begin the planning application process with local authorities.
4. Source quotes from at least three reputable contractors.

The Midlands region is known for its diverse architectural styles and historical properties, which often require careful planning and execution to preserve their unique characteristics. Renovation projects in this area can benefit from the availability of skilled tradespeople familiar with period properties. Additionally, the local planning authorities are generally supportive of renovation efforts that enhance energy efficiency and sustainability. However, it is crucial to engage with these authorities early in the planning process to ensure compliance with any regional restrictions or guidelines. The property market in the Midlands is relatively stable, with a steady demand for well-renovated homes, making this project a potentially lucrative investment.

This report provides indicative cost estimates based on publicly available 2025/26 UK construction cost data and the project details supplied. Actual costs will vary according to contractor, site conditions, specification changes, and market conditions at time of procurement. This report does not constitute professional advice. Always obtain a minimum of three competitive quotes from suitably qualified and insured contractors. UrbanBrief accepts no liability for decisions made on the basis of estimates herein. This report was prepared exclusively for gpb.bdd@gmail.com and should not be shared for any purpose other than initial budget planning.

DATA SOURCES

Cost benchmarks informed by RICS (Royal Institution of Chartered Surveyors), BCIS (Building Cost Information Service), ONS (Office for National Statistics), Rightmove, Zoopla and HM Land Registry. All figures reference 2025/26 published indices. Full methodology: urbanbrief.co.uk/data-sources

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